

that you'd like an inference from. The tooltip will appear and then SketchUp temporarily gives priority to that alignment.

2.3.5 Locking Inferences

In case you're finding it difficult to draw correctly and finding that you're not able to infer points as well as you could, it would really help to use the Inference Lock.

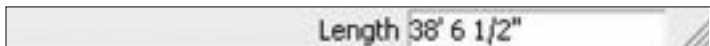
To lock an inference, simply hold down the [Shift] key whenever SketchUp infers the desired alignment. Instantly the line of inference will become thicker (bold).

This inference will now stay locked and you may wave the cursor around but the drawing will continue in the locked direction, while telling you apologetically that the drawing is "Constrained on Line".

Inferences may be locked along an axis direction, along an edge direction, on a face, from a point, parallel or perpendicular to an edge, etc.

2.4. Using The Value Control Box (VCB)

Another of the terrific facilities in SketchUp is the Value Control Box (VCB), which you can see as an empty box at the bottom-right of your screen, as a part of the Status Bar. What the VCB does, is show you the dimensions of the entity you are drawing while you are in the process of doing so (length of the line you're drawing, length and breadth of the rectangle / square you're drawing, radius of the circle you're drawing, etc.). If you keep your eye on the VCB while drawing, you can ensure that your creation has the measurements you want.



The VCB ensures a sound value system

However, you could also enter the exact value into the VCB so that the selected entity is of precisely the dimensions you wish.

The following tips will help you use the VCB better:

- You don't need to click in the box before you enter a value. Just start typing the numerals and they will appear in the Value Control Box.